

NE at BUF · Sunday 2026-10-04 13:00 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025. $n \geq 10$. No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

Line: NE +7.0 / BUF -7.0, total 48.5. Trip: NE → BUF 382 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: NE 7 days, BUF 7 days. Roof: outdoors.

1. Season boxes

Wk	Team	Spot	Score	Line	ATS	Off yds	Rush	Pass EPA	Off EPA	Def EPA allowed	SR	TO
1	NE	A at SEA	10–13	+3.0	push	287	109	-4.6	-6.6	+1.4	0.41	3
2	NE	H vs PIT	20–3	-4.5	cover	344	136	-1.3	-1.9	-22.2	0.43	2
3	NE	A at JAX	6–35	+3.0	miss	328	83	-13.9	-15.9	+11.8	0.37	3
1	BUF	A at HOU	36–31	-1.5	cover	420	86	+14.5	+15.6	+5.6	0.41	0
2	BUF	H vs DET	41–31	-5.5	cover	451	203	+15.0	+31.2	+18.3	0.59	0
3	BUF	H vs LAC	24–16	-7.0	cover	380	176	-0.4	-4.2	-4.5	0.48	5

Last game EPA (PBP): NE off -15.9, def allowed +11.8, net -27.8, SR 0.37. BUF off -4.2, def allowed -4.5, net +0.3, SR 0.48. Records: NE 1–2, BUF 3–0. ATS: NE 1–1, BUF 3–0.

2. Lookahead and rest

- NE: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, road, lost by 29). 7 days rest. Week 5: home vs LV, non-division, Sunday early window.
- BUF: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, home, won by 8). 7 days rest. Week 5: road vs LA, non-division, Monday night.

3. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: applies to NE
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: applies to BUF
- 2nd straight road game: applies to NE
- bye next week: no
- off a bye: no
- scored ≤ 10 last: applies to NE
- short week: no
- trip ≥ 1000 mi: no
- TO ≥ 3 last: applies to BUF, NE
- undefeated entering: no
- winless entering: no

4. Stack, without double-counting

Header per chair is the walk-forward record: traits picked by max parent-minus-child gap on seasons before N at $n \geq 10$, printed on season N, N = 2019–2025, pooled. Every printed game is out of sample. The full-window stack (picked on all seasons at $n \geq 20$) and its diagnostics sit in the block below it. Same gate on every slot.

Full-window stacks on both chairs resolve to the same games (mirror). The walk-forward folds pick traits per chair, so both blocks print.

- BUF -7.0** — one population: division home fav -7 to -9.5; off a win. Not added (no gap with $n \geq 20$ left): equal rest, off a 1-score win, off a cover, off a win as favorite, off a home game, 2nd straight home game, allowed ≤ 17 last, allowed ≤ 21 last....
- Walk-forward 4–5–1 (44.4%, n=10)** — picked on seasons before N, printed on N, 2019–25. By year: 19:0-1 20:1-2 21:1-0 22:0-2 23:1-0-1 24:0-0 25:1-0. OOS cover margin median -2.0, P(>+7) 0.30, P(<-7) 0.20. Traits picked in ≥ 4 of 7 folds: division home fav -7 to -9.5 (7/7).
- Full-window stack (picked on all seasons): division home fav -7 to -9.5; off a win. ATS 8–11–2 (42.1%, n=21).
- By season: 15:2-2 17:2-0 18:1-1 20:1-1 21:1-1 22:0-1 23:0-1 24:0-1 25:1-3
- Cover margin: median -1.5, q25/q75 -9.0/+13.0; P(>+7) 0.33, P(<-7) 0.33
- Parent minus child: without 'off a win': 16–14–2 (53.3%, n=32), the games it removed: 8–3 (72.7%, n=11)
- Anchor alone 16–14–2 (53.3%, n=32); anchor minus stack 8–3 (72.7%, n=11)
- Stack by line bucket: -7 to -9.5 8–11–2 (42.1%, n=21)

- Contrary cross: off a win, opponent off a loss: 5–8–1 (38.5%, n=14) → in stack 5–8–1 (38.5%, n=14) | off a win as favorite: 6–9–1 (40.0%, n=16) → in stack 6–9–1 (40.0%, n=16) | off a cover: 6–8–1 (42.9%, n=15) → in stack 6–8–1 (42.9%, n=15) | allowed ≤21 last: 7–8 (46.7%, n=15) → in stack 4–8 (33.3%, n=12)
- NE +7.0** — one population: division road dog +7 to +9.5; opponent off a win. Not added (no gap with n ≥ 20 left): equal rest, trip 200–1000 mi, 0 time zones, off a loss, off a loss by 10+, off a loss by 20+, off an ATS miss, off a loss as dog...
- Walk-forward 8–4–1 (66.7%, n=13)** — picked on seasons before N, printed on N, 2019–25. By year: 19:1-0 20:2-1 21:0-1 22:1-0 23:0-1-1 24:1-0 25:3-1. OOS cover margin median +4.5, P(>+7) 0.46, P(<-7) 0.31. Traits picked in ≥4 of 7 folds: division road dog +7 to +9.5 (7/7), trip 200–1000 mi (4/7).
- Full-window stack (picked on all seasons): division road dog +7 to +9.5; opponent off a win. ATS 11–8–2 (57.9%, n=21).
- By season: 15:2-2 17:0-2 18:1-1 20:1-1 21:1-1 22:1-0 23:1-0 24:1-0 25:3-1
- Cover margin: median +1.5, q25/q75 -13.0/+9.0; P(>+7) 0.33, P(<-7) 0.33
- Parent minus child: without 'opponent off a win': 14–16–2 (46.7%, n=32), the games it removed: 3–8 (27.3%, n=11)
- Anchor alone 14–16–2 (46.7%, n=32); anchor minus stack 3–8 (27.3%, n=11)
- Stack by line bucket: +7 to +9.5 11–8–2 (57.9%, n=21)
- Contrary cross: 0 time zones: 5–10–2 (33.3%, n=17) → in stack 4–6–2 (40.0%, n=12) | next game is home: 7–12–1 (36.8%, n=20) → in stack 6–7–1 (46.2%, n=14) | outdoors: 7–11–1 (38.9%, n=19) → in stack 5–5–1 (50.0%, n=11) | off a loss by 10+: 4–7 (36.4%, n=11) → in stack 3–3 (50.0%, n=6)
- Total 48.5** — tightest full-window cut clearing n = 20: home fav –7 or more, both off EPA ≤ –1 last — O–U 12–23 (34.3%, n=35).
- By season (O–U): 15:1-1 16:0-2 17:3-3 18:1-2 19:1-1 20:2-0 21:1-1 22:1-3 23:0-4 24:0-2 25:2-4
- Total margin (points – line): median -4.5, q25/q75 -10.8/+2.8; P(>+7) 0.17, P(<-7) 0.40
- Walk-forward 4–7 in the training cut's direction (36.4%, n=11; raw O–U 3–8)** — cut chosen on seasons before N, printed on N; O/U after each year is the direction the training cut pointed. By year: 19:2-1O 20:0-4O 21:1-2O 22:0-0U 23:0-1U 24:0-0U 25:0-0U. OOS total margin median -7.0. Cuts picked: home fav –7 or more, both teams went under last week, total 45–49 (4/7), outdoors, home fav –7 or more, total 45–49 (2/7), both off EPA ≤ –1 last, total ≥47 (1/7).
- By total band: ≤39 0–3 (n=3); 40–44 8–9 (n=17); 45–49 3–8 (n=11); ≥50 1–2 (n=3)

Appendix A. Sides — BUF –7.0

BUF (home favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
home favorite	265–294–16	47.4%	575
Sunday early window home favorite	145–150–10	49.2%	305
division home favorite	74–84–5	46.8%	163
home fav –7 to –9.5	51–60–3	45.9%	114
division home fav –7 to –9.5	16–14–2	53.3%	32
Sunday early window division home favorite	36–53–3	40.4%	92
Sunday early window fav –7 to –9.5	39–45–2	46.4%	86
Sunday early window home fav –7 to –9.5	30–28–1	51.7%	59

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off a win as favorite, Sunday early window division home favorite	9–22–1	29.0%	32
off a win, home fav –7 to –9.5	25–42–3	37.3%	70
next game is prime time, home fav –7 to –9.5	8–18–2	30.8%	28
equal rest, Sunday early window division home favorite	19–33–2	36.5%	54
rush yards ≥150 last, Sunday early window division home favorite	7–16	30.4%	23
next game is road non-division, Sunday early window division home favorite	19–32–2	37.3%	53
opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday early window division home favorite	16–28–1	36.4%	45
TO ≥3 last, home favorite	28–43–3	39.4%	74
off a win, opponent off a loss, home fav –7 to –9.5	17–29–2	37.0%	48
next opponent is a favorite over them (n_line>0), division home fav –7 to –9.5	9–3–1	75.0%	13
off a win as favorite, home fav –7 to –9.5	20–32–2	38.5%	54
next game is road, Sunday early window division home favorite	27–40–2	40.3%	69
opponent off an ATS miss, home favorite	124–150–8	45.3%	282

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
TO ≥3 last, Sunday early window division home favorite	3–8	27.3%	11
won last despite off EPA ≤ −1, Sunday early window division home favorite	5–11	31.2%	16
rush yards ≥150 last, division home favorite	14–23	37.8%	37
off a win, opponent off a loss, division home favorite	18–28–2	39.1%	48
2nd straight home game, home favorite	75–94–4	44.4%	173
off a win, opponent off a loss, Sunday early window division home favorite	11–19–1	36.7%	31
off a home game, Sunday early window division home favorite	11–19	36.7%	30
off a 1-score win, Sunday early window home favorite	48–35–5	57.8%	88
equal rest, home favorite	154–180–10	46.1%	344
next opponent is a favorite over them (n_line>0), home favorite	116–138–5	45.7%	259
next game is road, home favorite	179–206–8	46.5%	393
off a win as favorite, division home favorite	22–32–1	40.7%	55
opponent off a loss, Sunday early window division home favorite	23–33–2	41.1%	58
opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday early window fav −7 to −9.5	23–33–1	41.1%	57
off a home game, home fav −7 to −9.5	15–23–1	39.5%	39

Wide populations (n ≥ 300): equal rest, home favorite, next game is road, home favorite. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

Appendix B. Sides — NE +7.0

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

NE (road dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
road dog	294–265–16	52.6%	575
Sunday early window road dog	150–145–10	50.8%	305
division road dog	84–74–5	53.2%	163
road dog +7 to +9.5	60–51–3	54.1%	114
division road dog +7 to +9.5	14–16–2	46.7%	32
Sunday early window division road dog	53–36–3	59.6%	92
Sunday early window dog +7 to +9.5	45–39–2	53.6%	86
Sunday early window road dog +7 to +9.5	28–30–1	48.3%	59

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
trip 200–1000 mi, Sunday early window division road dog	46–21	68.7%	67
trip 200–1000 mi, division road dog	72–42–2	63.2%	116
trip 200–1000 mi, road dog	179–135–6	57.0%	320
opponent off a win, road dog +7 to +9.5	42–25–3	62.7%	70
equal rest, Sunday early window division road dog	33–19–2	63.5%	54
trip 200–1000 mi, Sunday early window road dog	107–81–3	56.9%	191
off an ATS miss, Sunday early window division road dog	28–16–1	63.6%	45
off a loss, opponent off a win, road dog +7 to +9.5	29–17–2	63.0%	48
off a loss by 20+, Sunday early window road dog	23–13	63.9%	36
off EPA ≤ −1 last, Sunday early window division road dog	28–17	62.2%	45
off an ATS miss, road dog	150–124–8	54.7%	282
next game is home non-division, Sunday early window road dog +7 to +9.5	9–17	34.6%	26
net EPA ≤ −10 last, Sunday early window division road dog	21–12–1	63.6%	34
scored ≤17 last, Sunday early window division road dog	22–13–1	62.9%	36
off a loss, opponent off a win, division road dog	28–18–2	60.9%	48

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off a loss, opponent off a win, Sunday early window division road dog	19–11–1	63.3%	31
equal rest, road dog	180–154–10	53.9%	344
scored ≤17 last, Sunday early window dog +7 to +9.5	26–17–1	60.5%	44
off a loss, Sunday early window division road dog	33–23–2	58.9%	58
off an ATS miss, Sunday early window dog +7 to +9.5	33–23–1	58.9%	57
outdoors, Sunday early window division road dog	35–25–3	58.3%	63
0 time zones, division road dog +7 to +9.5	5–10–2	33.3%	17
equal rest, Sunday early window dog +7 to +9.5	29–20–2	59.2%	51
opponent off a win, Sunday early window division road dog	30–21–2	58.8%	53
2nd straight road game, Sunday early window division road dog	19–12	61.3%	31
next game is home non-division, division road dog	34–45–3	43.0%	82
allowed ≥30 last, road dog +7 to +9.5	25–17	59.5%	42
trip 200–1000 mi, division road dog +7 to +9.5	11–6–1	64.7%	18

Wide populations (n ≥ 300): trip 200–1000 mi, road dog, equal rest, road dog. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

Appendix C. Total 48.5 — n ≥ 10 cuts

Cut	Over–Under	Over pct	n
home fav –7 or more, both teams went under last week, total 45–49	2–9	18.2%	11
home fav –7 or more, both off EPA ≤ –1 last	12–23	34.3%	35
both off EPA ≤ –1 last, total ≥47	20–10	66.7%	30
home fav –7 or more, both teams went under last week	14–25	35.9%	39
home fav –7 or more, total ≥47	26–39–1	40.0%	66
outdoors, both off EPA ≤ –1 last, total ≥47	13–6	68.4%	19
home fav –7 or more, both teams went under last week, total ≥47	4–10	28.6%	14
home fav –7 or more, both off EPA ≤ –1 last, total 45–49	3–8	27.3%	11
division game, both off EPA ≤ –1 last	23–34	40.4%	57
Sunday early window, outdoors, total 45–49	84–67–1	55.6%	152
both off EPA ≤ –1 last	78–96	44.8%	174
division game, both teams went under last week	30–41	42.3%	71
division game, Sunday early window, total ≥47	29–20–1	59.2%	50
division game, both teams went under last week, total 45–49	8–14	36.4%	22
division game, both off EPA ≤ –1 last, total ≥47	7–3	70.0%	10
Sunday early window, both off EPA ≤ –1 last	47–60	43.9%	107
Sunday early window, both off EPA ≤ –1 last, total ≥47	11–6	64.7%	17
Sunday early window, total 45–49	106–90–1	54.1%	197
both teams went under last week, both off EPA ≤ –1 last, total ≥47	9–5	64.3%	14
division game, both teams went under last week, total ≥47	5–9	35.7%	14
division game, home fav –7 or more, total 45–49	9–14	39.1%	23
outdoors, total ≥47	109–124–3	46.8%	236

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats_team_week 2015–2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play_by_play 2015–2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).